

Project Proposal:
Mobile Application - TownHappening

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INFO-C 342 – Mobile Application Development

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Project Proposal

1) App Concept and Purpose

Problem

Residents of small towns struggle to discover local events because event information is scattered across multiple communication channels (e.g. Facebook, Instagram, physical flyers, government websites. As a result, residents must check everywhere or risk missing out entirely. Major apps like Eventbrite and Meetup are primarily designed for larger cities or group based communities which leaves small town residents underserved.

Who the Users Are

TownHappening is designed for residents of small towns who want a simple, centralized way to stay connected with what is happening in their community. Based on user research conducted in Northwest Indiana, target users include:

- Lifelong residents who want to stay involved in their community
- Parents looking for family-friendly local activities
- Young adults who discover events through social media but find it unreliable
- Newcomers who are unfamiliar with how local events are communicated

Key Features

- Event Browse Screen: A scrollable list of the upcoming local events with the title, date, category, and location
- Event Detail Screen: Full details for a selected event including description, time, location, and share button

- Favorites: Users can save events they are interested in using a heart icon which will be stored locally on the device
- Category Filter: Filter events by type (e.g. Music, Food, Family, Community, Sports)
- Share Events: Share event details with friends via the share_plus package

2) GUI Design and Sketches

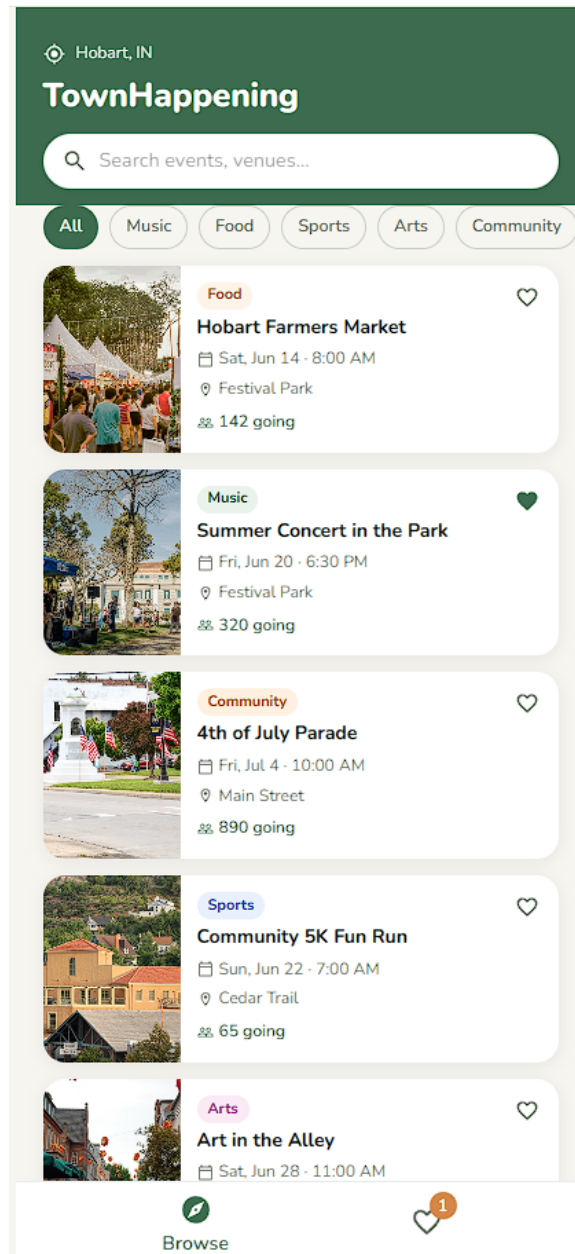


Figure 1: Home Screen

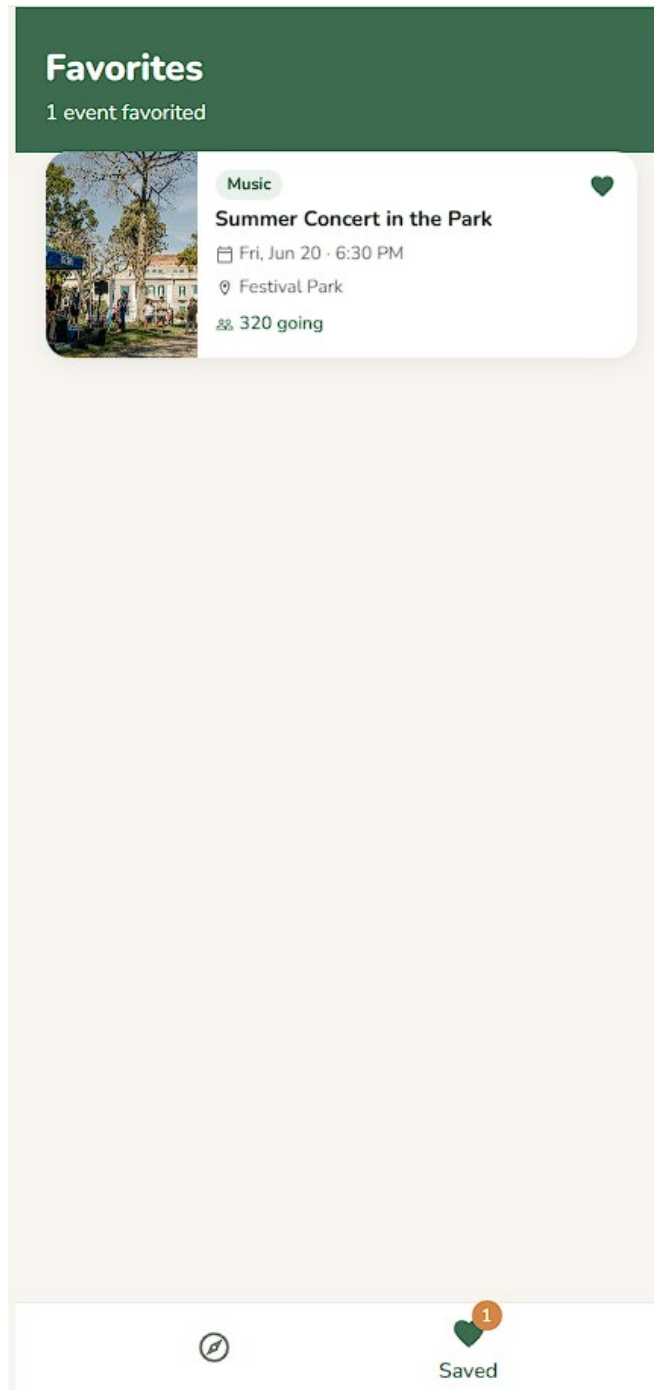


Figure 2: Favorites EventsScreen

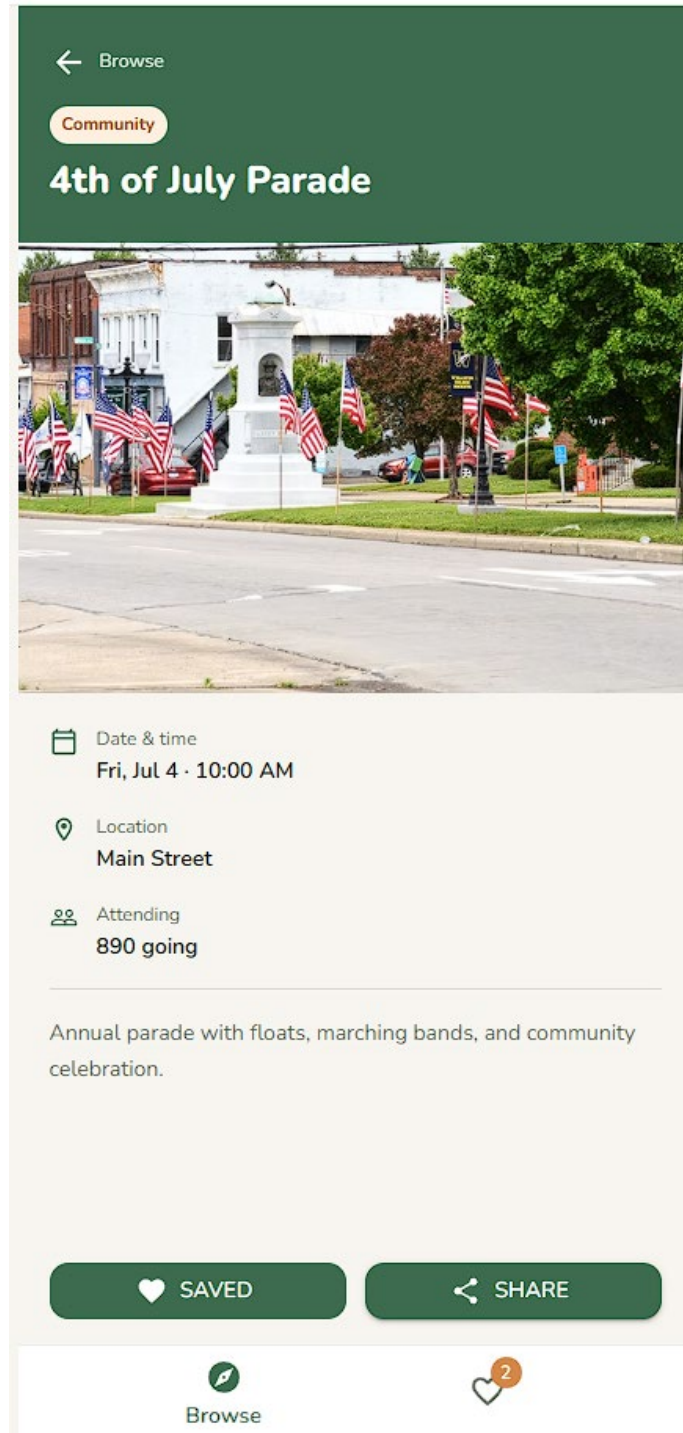


Figure 3: Event Detail Screen

Screen	Description
Home	Scrollable list of upcoming events. Each card shows event name, date, category badge, and a favorite icon. A filter row at the top allows filtering by category.
Event Detail	Full event information screen opened via <code>Navigator.pushNamed</code> . Shows title, date/time, location, description, and a Share button using <code>share_plus</code> .
Favorited Events	A dedicated screen showing all events the user has favorited. Favorites are persisted using <code>SharedPreferences</code> so they survive app restarts.

3) Technical Plan and Learning

Technical Plan

- `Navigator.pushNamed`: Multi-screen navigation (already practiced in HW07)
- `SharedPreferences`: Persisting favorited events across app sessions
- `share_plus` : Allowing users to share event info to other apps
- Hardcoded Dart event objects: Structured mock data simulating a real event database
- `ListView.builder`: Efficient scrollable event list rendering
- Category filter logic: Filtering the displayed event list by category using Dart
- Card widgets and custom theming: Polished, consistent UI design

Learning

- `SharedPreferences`: Flutter official documentation at docs.flutter.dev and pub.dev package page
- `share_plus`: pub.dev documentation (already explored in HW07)
- UI design and theming: Flutter Widget Catalog and community examples on GitHub

4) Timeline and Milestones

Dates	Tasks	Milestone
June 8–10	Finalize app concept, create Figma wireframes for all 3 screens, set up Flutter project	<i>Proposal submitted</i>
June 11–14	Build Event model class, hardcode event data, build Home/Browse screen with ListView.builder and event cards	<i>Browse screen functional</i>
June 15–17	Build Event Detail screen, implement Navigator.pushNamed routing between screens	<i>Navigation working</i>
June 18–20	Implement Favorites feature using SharedPreferences persistence	<i>Favorites working & persisted</i>
June 21–22	Add category filter bar, implement share_plus on detail screen, polish UI and theming	<i>Checkpoint (June 23)</i>
June 23–25	Bug fixes, test on emulator, write final report, record demo video	<i>Final submission (June 29)</i>

5) Market Comparison

Eventbrite

Eventbrite is the biggest event discovery website out there; organizers can create and promote their own events while consumers can discover and purchase tickets for them. Although

it is very useful, it mainly deals with ticketed, larger, and city-type events. For example, small-town free events like local summer festivals or farmers' markets are not adequately covered. Moreover, organizers have to sign up and create an event for the Eventbrite website, something that most small-town organizers do not do. The alternative, TownHappening, caters to small towns only; it shows community events without requiring any sort of registration process or tickets to be purchased.

Meetup

Meetup is a website that focuses on connecting people through events based on mutual interests. In other words, it is highly group-oriented since individuals need to become members of certain groups in order to view related events. Moreover, it tends to cater to cities and tech enthusiasts as well as fitness and hobby-based groups rather than towns and general events like parades, markets, or concerts.

Uniqueness

- Focused exclusively on small towns where existing platforms fall short
- No account creation or group membership required to browse events
- Simple, beginner-friendly UI designed for all age groups
- Favorites feature allows personal event tracking without social pressure
- Built with the community in mind, not commercial ticketing